

Guideline Title: Hypothermia

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-M012

Issue date: 09/09/2014	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 4/30/24	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Dr. Christopher Hunter, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

- I. **PURPOSE:** Recognize hypothermia and provide/maintain adequate oxygenation, ventilation, end-organ tissue perfusion, temperature control. Provide expeditious transport to the nearest appropriate facility.
- II. **DEFINITIONS:** none
- III. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**
 - a. Establish care as defined by *GUID3203-G002 – General Patient Care*
 - b. Remove patient from cold environment to somewhere warm. Remove wet clothing. Handle patient gently to avoid subsequent dysrhythmias.
 - c. Attempt to obtain a history regarding the circumstances surrounding the cold exposure.
 - d. Perform a blood glucose check from a venous access site and if glucose is < 60 mg/dL, and patient is symptomatic, treat per *GUID3203-M021 – Hypoglycemia*.
 - e. If possible, assess core body temperature in bladder, rectum, or with esophageal probe.
 - f. Administer warmed IV fluids per *GUID3203-PR026 Warming of Blood Products & Intravenous Fluids*.
 - g. If core temperature is between 34-36°C: Gradually re-warm using blankets, heat packs (with barrier between pack and patient), and external warming devices (if available).
 - h. If core temperature is between 30-34°C: Actively re-warm the trunk of the body. Do not attempt to re-warm extremities.
 - i. If patient in cardiac arrest, and the core temperature is < 30°C
 - i. Continue CPR; however, withhold all IV medications.
 - ii. If the patient is in ventricular fibrillation or ventricular tachycardia, limit the number of defibrillation attempts to a maximum of three.
 - j. If the patient is in cardiac arrest, and the core temperature is > 30°C
 - i. Assess for bradycardia. Continue cardiopulmonary resuscitation. Administer IV medications as clinically indicated, prolonging the standard intervals at which they are administered.
 - ii. If ventricular fibrillation or ventricular tachycardia, repeat defibrillation as the core temperature rises.
- IV. **DOCUMENTATION:**
 - a. EMS Charts

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V. REFERENCES: